

SPACE

The universe is made up of galaxies, stars, planets, moons, and other bodies scattered throughout space.

A galaxy is a group of billions of stars: our galaxy, which is shaped like a spiral, is called the Milky Way.

On a clear night, it is possible to see thousands of stars, which appear as twinkling points of light. The Earth's

moon is usually clear, and sometimes you can also see five of the planets: Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, and Saturn. These do not

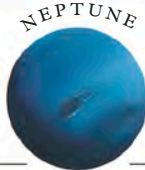
twinkle, but look like small steady discs of light. Earth is the third planet from the sun, which is about 93 million miles (150 million kilometers) away from us. People have always

Space
shuttle

been curious about the things they could see in the sky. It is only quite recently, though, that science has developed the advanced technology needed to send people into space.



Milky Way



SATURN